

Alex Falcon

Systems Generalist

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Summary

Curious generalist building reliable systems with a taste for weird constraints.

Highlights

- Reduced cold-start latency for services by 47% using a staged prewarming pipeline.
- Consolidated 60+ jobs into a single DAG with clear SLAs and backpressure.

Skills

Programming languages Rust (*advanced, 21 mo*), Kotlin (*advanced, 18 mo*), TypeScript (*intermediate, 26 mo*)

Data/Storage PostgreSQL (*advanced, 39 mo*), Redis (*advanced, 44 mo*), MongoDB (*intermediate*)

Platforms/Infrastructure Kubernetes (*advanced, 23 mo*), Terraform (*intermediate, 5 mo*), Nix (*intermediate, 5 mo*), Prometheus (*advanced, 21 mo*), gRPC (*advanced, 39 mo*)

Experience

Aug 2022 – Nov 2024 (27 mo) **Platform Engineer**, Acme Orbits, Cloudport, Terra

Rust, PostgreSQL, gRPC, Prometheus, Nix, Terraform, Kubernetes

- **Software Engineer** — Aug 2022 – Jan 2023

○ **Event Pulse** — Feb 2023 – Nov 2024 (21 mo)

High-rate event ingestion with adaptive batching and idempotent sinks.

Stack: Rust (*advanced*), PostgreSQL (*advanced*), gRPC (*advanced*), Prometheus (*advanced*).

Responsibilities:

- Implemented backpressure-aware gRPC producers.
- Tuned Postgres partitioning for 2B rows/month.

Links: [repository](#), [documentation](#), [example](#), [site](#).

Contributions: [prom-community/awesome-exporters](#) — Added exporter config examples.

○ **orbitctl** — Aug 2022 – Jan 2023 (5 mo)

Unified CLI to bootstrap environments and rotate secrets.

Stack: Nix (*intermediate*), Terraform (*intermediate*), Kubernetes (*advanced*).

Responsibilities:

- Added hermetic builds via Nix flakes.

Jan 2021 – Nov 2022 (22 mo) **Software Engineer**, Nebula Foundry, New Arcadia

Kotlin, PostgreSQL, Redis, gRPC, TypeScript

○ **Nebula Graph Sync** — Jan 2021 – Jul 2022 (18 mo)

Incremental sync engine for heterogeneous data sources.

Stack: Kotlin (*advanced*), PostgreSQL (*advanced*), Redis (*advanced*), gRPC (*advanced*).

Responsibilities:

- Designed a resumable protocol with at-least-once semantics.

○ **Nebula Community Site** (*volunteering*) — Mar 2022 – Nov 2022 (8 mo)

Volunteer-driven portal for documentation and tutorials.

Stack: TypeScript (*intermediate*), Redis (*advanced*).

Responsibilities:

- Organized content sprints and triaged community PRs.
- Established tagging taxonomy improving discoverability.

Contributions: [nixos/nixpkgs](#) — Derivation improvements.

Mar 2019 – Sep 2020 (18 mo) **Contributor**, *OpenAtlas* (*volunteering*)
TypeScript, *Redis*, *Kubernetes*

- **OpenAtlas Maps** — Mar 2019 – Sep 2020 (18 mo)

Community tooling for map tiling and preview.

Stack: TypeScript (*intermediate*), Redis (*advanced*), Kubernetes (*advanced*).

Responsibilities:

- Built tile cache and prerender queue.

Links: [repository](#), [site](#), [example](#).

Education

2016 – 2018 **MSc**, *University of Solaris*, Aurora, Solaris
Distributed Systems

2012 – 2016 **BSc**, *Terra Polytechnic*, Terra Prime
Computer Engineering

Courses

- Streaming Systems — OpenLearn (2021)
- Reliable Infrastructure — In-house (2023)

Awards

- Solar Hack 2022 winner
- Infra Excellence 2023 laureate

Certifications

- CKAD — Certified Kubernetes Application Developer — CNCF (2022)
- HashiCorp Certified — Terraform Associate — HashiCorp (2021)

Languages

- English — native
- Russian — B2 (upper-intermediate)
- German — B1 (intermediate)
- Spanish — A2 (elementary)
- Japanese — A1 (beginner)

Publications

- Idempotent event pipelines at scale — TechConf 2024
- Debugging backpressure in production — DevOps Weekly #312

Talks

- Backpressure in gRPC: practical techniques
- Nix for reproducible builds in a multi-repo

Interests

- Retrocomputing
- Bouldering
- Generative music
- Variable typography

References

- **Dana Ortiz**, Staff Engineer — Mentor at Acme Orbits.
Consistently delivered under pressure and raised the bar for reliability.
Contact: e-mail: dana.ortiz@example.com, LinkedIn: <https://linkedin.com/in/dana-ortiz>
- **Ilya Serebrov**, SRE Manager — Manager at Nebula Foundry.
Pragmatic engineer with strong ownership and great collaboration skills.
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